EchoCampus Institute of Technology

Student Handbook of Rules & Policies

Academic Session 2026–27

Sample document. This handbook was prepared as demo data for the EchoCampus grievance portal project. EchoCampus Institute of Technology is a fictional institution. Rules that come from national regulations (UGC anti-ragging regulations 2009, UGC student grievance regulations 2023, UGC fee refund policy) follow those regulations; all other rules, contacts and amounts are illustrative only.

Contents

1. General Provisions
2. Student Code of Conduct
3. Attendance & Academics
4. Examinations & Results
5. Fee Payment & Refund Policy
6. Hostel Rules
7. Mess & Canteen
8. Anti-Ragging Policy
9. Prevention of Sexual Harassment
10. IT, Internet & Wi-Fi Usage
11. Library Rules
12. Campus Infrastructure & Maintenance
13. Transport
14. Health, Safety & Student Wellbeing
15. Student Grievance Redressal Policy
16. Disciplinary Procedure
17. Important Contacts

1. General Provisions

1.1 This handbook applies to every student enrolled at EchoCampus Institute of Technology (the Institute), in all programmes, for the academic session 2026–27.

1.2 By taking admission, every student agrees to follow the rules in this handbook and any notices issued by the Institute during the session.

1.3 Where a rule here conflicts with a regulation of the University Grants Commission (UGC) or any law in force, the UGC regulation or law prevails.

1.4 The Institute may amend these rules. Amendments are published on the official notice board and the EchoCampus portal and take effect from the date stated in the notice.

1.5 Questions about any rule can be asked through the Policy Assistant on the EchoCampus portal or at the Student Welfare Office.

2. Student Code of Conduct

2.1 Students must carry their Institute ID card at all times on campus and show it when asked by staff or security.

2.2 Students must treat fellow students, faculty and staff with respect. Abusive language, threats, bullying or discrimination based on caste, religion, gender, region, language or disability is prohibited.

2.3 Smoking, alcohol, drugs and any intoxicating substances are strictly prohibited on campus and in hostels.

2.4 Damaging Institute property is prohibited. The cost of repair or replacement will be recovered from the student(s) responsible, in addition to disciplinary action.

2.5 Students may not post content on social media that defames the Institute, its students or staff, or shares private information or photos of others without consent.

2.6 Political or religious gatherings on campus require prior written permission from the Dean of Student Welfare.

2.7 Dress on campus should be neat and decent. Laboratories and workshops have their own safety dress rules, which must be followed.

3. Attendance & Academics

3.1 A minimum of 75% attendance in each course (theory and practical counted separately) is required to be eligible for the end-semester examination.

3.2 Attendance shortage of up to 10% (that is, attendance between 65% and 75%) may be condoned by the Head of Department only for documented medical reasons or Institute-approved activities such as sports, NCC/NSS or official competitions.

3.3 Medical certificates for condonation must be submitted within 7 days of returning to classes. Late certificates will not be accepted.

3.4 Attendance is updated on the academic portal every week. Errors in recorded attendance must be reported to the course faculty within 7 days of the update; after that, the record is treated as final.

3.5 Students who are detained for shortage of attendance must re-register for the course in a later semester.

3.6 Each course has a faculty mentor. Students facing academic difficulty should contact their mentor first; unresolved academic issues may be raised as an Examination/Academic complaint on the

EchoCampus portal.

4. Examinations & Results

4.1 Admit cards are issued only to students who meet the attendance requirement and have no pending fee dues.

4.2 Students must reach the examination hall at least 15 minutes before the start. Entry is not allowed more than 30 minutes after the examination begins.

4.3 Mobile phones, smart watches and any electronic devices are not allowed inside the examination hall, even if switched off.

4.4 Use of unfair means (copying, carrying notes, impersonation, or communicating with others) leads to cancellation of that paper at minimum. Repeat or serious cases may lead to cancellation of the whole semester's examinations.

4.5 Results are published on the academic portal. A student may apply for re-evaluation of an answer script within 7 days of the result, with a fee of Rs. 500 per paper. If marks increase by 10% or more of the maximum marks, the fee is refunded.

4.6 A student who misses an end-semester examination for a documented medical emergency may apply for a make-up examination within 3 days of the missed paper.

4.7 Mark sheets are issued within 30 days of result declaration. Errors in mark sheets (name, marks, subject codes) should be reported through the portal under the Examination category.

5. Fee Payment & Refund Policy

5A. Fee payment

5.1 Semester fees must be paid by the due date in the fee notice. A late fee of Rs. 50 per day applies after the due date, up to a maximum of Rs. 2,000.

5.2 Students with fee dues of more than 30 days after the due date may have their portal access for results and admit cards withheld until the dues are cleared.

5.3 Students facing genuine financial hardship may apply to the Accounts Office for payment in two instalments. Requests must be made before the due date.

5.4 Scholarship amounts are adjusted against fees only after the scholarship is credited to the Institute. Students remain responsible for the fee until then.

5B. Refund on withdrawal of admission (as per UGC fee refund policy)

If a student withdraws from a programme, refunds are made under the five-tier system below, based on when the written withdrawal request is received compared with the formally notified last date of admission.

Refund of fees	When the withdrawal request is received
100% (minus a processing fee of not more than Rs. 1,000)	15 days or more before the last date of admission
90%	Less than 15 days before the last date of admission
80%	15 days or less after the last date of admission
50%	More than 15 days but not more than 30 days after the last date of admission

Refund of fees	When the withdrawal request is received
0%	More than 30 days after the last date of admission

5.5 Caution money and security deposits are fully refundable on withdrawal or on completion of the programme, after deducting any dues.

5.6 Refunds are made by bank transfer to the account given in the withdrawal form, within 15 working days of the request being approved.

5.7 Hostel fees are refunded in proportion to unused full months if a student vacates the hostel with written approval; mess advance is refunded after deducting meals availed.

5.8 Complaints about refund delays may be raised under the Fee/Finance category on the EchoCampus portal and are handled under the Student Grievance Redressal Policy (Section 15).

6. Hostel Rules

6.1 Hostel rooms are allotted for one academic year. Room changes need written approval from the Warden.

6.2 Hostel gates close at 9:30 PM for all residents. Late entry is allowed only with prior permission from the Warden or with a valid out-pass.

6.3 Residents leaving the hostel overnight must apply for an out-pass on the hostel register or portal at least 24 hours in advance. For first-year students, out-passes require parent/guardian confirmation.

6.4 Visitors are allowed only in the visitors' lounge between 4:00 PM and 7:00 PM. Visitors of the opposite gender are not allowed inside residential floors.

6.5 Cooking appliances, heaters, immersion rods and any high-wattage devices are not allowed in rooms. Laptops, phone chargers and table lamps are allowed.

6.6 Residents are responsible for the furniture and fittings in their room. Damage found at the end of the year is charged to the occupants.

6.7 Maintenance issues in hostels (electricity, plumbing, furniture, cleanliness) should be raised as a Hostel complaint on the EchoCampus portal. Urgent issues such as water leakage or electrical sparking should also be reported to the hostel caretaker immediately.

6.8 Hostel Wi-Fi is provided under the IT rules in Section 10. Wi-Fi outages in hostels are handled by the IT department and should be reported under the IT/Internet category.

6.9 Ragging in any form inside the hostel leads to immediate expulsion from the hostel, in addition to the action described in Section 8.

7. Mess & Canteen

7.1 Mess timings: breakfast 7:30–9:00 AM, lunch 12:30–2:30 PM, snacks 5:00–6:00 PM, dinner 7:30–9:30 PM.

7.2 The weekly menu is decided by the Mess Committee, which includes elected student representatives, and is displayed in the mess every Sunday.

7.3 Residents going on approved leave for 5 or more consecutive days may claim a mess rebate for those days. The claim must be made through the hostel office before leaving.

7.4 Complaints about food quality, hygiene or stale food should be raised under the Canteen/Mess category on the EchoCampus portal, ideally with a photo as proof. Food safety complaints are treated as High priority.

7.5 Canteen prices are fixed by the Institute and displayed at the counter. Overcharging should be reported through the portal.

8. Anti-Ragging Policy

The Institute has zero tolerance for ragging. This policy follows the UGC Regulations on Curbing the Menace of Ragging in Higher Educational Institutions, 2009, which are mandatory for all institutions.

8.1 **What counts as ragging:** any act by a student that teases, treats rudely or harms a fellow student (especially a fresher or junior), causes physical or mental harm, fear or shame, forces someone to do something they would not do willingly, or exploits a junior for financial gain, academic work or any other purpose. This includes verbal, physical, written, online and social media acts.

8.2 Every student and their parent or guardian must submit the online anti-ragging undertaking every academic year at www.antiragging.in.

8.3 The Institute has an Anti-Ragging Committee, which decides on punishments, and an Anti-Ragging Squad, which makes surprise checks at hostels, canteens, buses and other vulnerable places, and investigates complaints.

8.4 **How to report:** a victim or a witness can report ragging through the EchoCampus portal (Ragging category, always treated as Critical), to any member of the Anti-Ragging Committee or Squad, to the Warden, or to the National Anti-Ragging Helpline at 1800-180-5522 (24x7, toll free) or helpline@antiragging.in.

8.5 Complaints of ragging are acted on immediately. The identity of the complainant is kept confidential.

8.6 **Punishments** depend on the nature and seriousness of the act and may include one or more of: suspension from classes and academic privileges; withholding of scholarships or other benefits; debarring from tests, examinations or events; withholding of results; suspension or expulsion from the hostel or mess; cancellation of admission; suspension or expulsion from the Institute; a fine; and a public apology.

8.7 Where students involved in ragging cannot be identified, the Institute may resort to collective punishment, as allowed by the UGC regulations.

8.8 Ragging is also a criminal offence. In serious cases the Institute will file an FIR with the police in addition to its own action.

9. Prevention of Sexual Harassment

9.1 The Institute is committed to a campus free from sexual harassment, in line with the UGC (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal of Sexual Harassment of Women Employees and Students in Higher Educational Institutions) Regulations, 2015.

9.2 Sexual harassment complaints are handled by the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), not by the general grievance committee. Students can reach the ICC directly at icc@echocampus.example.

9.3 A complaint raised on the EchoCampus portal under the Harassment category is treated as Critical and forwarded confidentially to the ICC.

9.4 Complainants and witnesses are protected from retaliation. Any act of retaliation is itself treated as serious misconduct.

10. IT, Internet & Wi-Fi Usage

10.1 Every student receives an Institute email ID and Wi-Fi login. Login details must not be shared with anyone.

10.2 Institute Wi-Fi and computers may not be used for illegal downloads, hacking, accessing prohibited content, or any activity that harms the network.

10.3 Campus Wi-Fi is available 24x7 in academic blocks and hostels, subject to maintenance windows announced in advance.

10.4 Wi-Fi or internet outages should be reported under the IT/Internet category on the EchoCampus portal. If several students report the same outage, students should support (+1) the existing complaint instead of filing a new one.

10.5 Lab computers must not be used to install software without permission from the lab in-charge.

10.6 Problems with the Learning Management System (LMS), such as being unable to submit an assignment, should be reported to the IT department through the portal before the submission deadline. Faculty may grant an extension when an IT complaint was raised before the deadline.

11. Library Rules

11.1 The library is open 8:00 AM to 10:00 PM on working days and 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM on Sundays and holidays. During examinations, timings may be extended.

11.2 Undergraduate students may borrow up to 4 books at a time for 14 days. A book may be renewed once if no other student has reserved it.

11.3 A fine of Rs. 5 per book per day applies for late returns. Lost or damaged books must be replaced or paid for at current price.

11.4 Silence must be kept in reading areas. Phones must be on silent mode.

11.5 Access to online journals and e-books is available through the Institute network and the library portal.

12. Campus Infrastructure & Maintenance

12.1 Problems with classrooms, laboratories, washrooms, drinking water, furniture, electricity, lifts or projectors should be reported under the Infrastructure category on the EchoCampus portal.

12.2 Safety hazards, such as exposed wiring, broken railings or gas leaks in labs, must be reported immediately to security or the lab in-charge, and also raised on the portal. These are treated as Critical.

12.3 Drinking water coolers are cleaned and their filters checked every month. Students should report any water quality issue through the portal.

12.4 Students should attach a photo of the problem with their complaint wherever possible. This helps the maintenance team act faster.

13. Transport

13.1 Institute buses run on fixed routes published at the start of each semester. Bus passes are issued per semester on payment of the transport fee.

13.2 Students must show their bus pass when boarding. Buses do not wait beyond the scheduled departure time.

13.3 Complaints about bus delays, rash driving, overcrowding or behaviour of staff should be raised under the Transport category on the EchoCampus portal, with the bus number and time.

14. Health, Safety & Student Wellbeing

14.1 The campus medical room is open 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM on working days, with a nurse on call for hostel residents at night. In an emergency, call the campus emergency line or the national emergency number 112.

14.2 The Institute has a student counselling service. Appointments are free and confidential and can be booked at the Student Welfare Office or by email to counsellor@echocampus.example.

14.3 Students who are feeling overwhelmed, anxious or low can also call Tele-MANAS, the national mental health helpline, at 14416 (free, 24x7).

14.4 Any complaint that mentions self-harm or a threat to someone's safety is treated as Critical. The student will immediately be shown counselling and helpline contacts, and the Student Welfare team will reach out.

14.5 Fire drills are held once every semester. Students must know the emergency exits of their hostel and academic block.

15. Student Grievance Redressal Policy

This policy follows the UGC (Redressal of Grievances of Students) Regulations, 2023. The EchoCampus portal is the official channel for student complaints.

15A. How complaints are raised and handled

15.1 Any student can raise a complaint on the EchoCampus portal after logging in with their verified Institute email. Proof such as photos, screenshots, PDF or Word documents can be attached (up to 5 files, 5 MB each).

15.2 Complaint categories: Academic, Examination, Hostel, Canteen/Mess, Infrastructure, IT/Internet, Library, Transport, Fee/Finance, Ragging, Harassment, Discrimination and Other.

15.3 Each complaint is routed to the Grievance Manager responsible for its category. Ragging, harassment and safety complaints are always treated as Critical and are alerted to the Admin immediately.

15.4 Before raising a complaint, students are encouraged to check the Policy Assistant on the portal. Many questions about rules, fees and timings are answered there instantly from this handbook.

15B. Resolution time limits

Priority	Examples	Target resolution time
Critical	Ragging, harassment, threats to safety, self-harm concerns, serious safety hazards	4 hours (first action)
High	Food safety, complete Wi-Fi/electricity outage in a hostel, exam-related urgent issues	2 days
Medium	Broken furniture, projector not working, library or transport issues	3 days
Low	Suggestions, minor cleanliness issues, general requests	7 days

15.5 If a complaint is not resolved within its time limit, it is automatically escalated to the Admin.

15.6 When a Grievance Manager marks a complaint as resolved, the student who raised it is asked to confirm whether the issue was actually fixed. If the student says it was not, the complaint is reopened. If the student does not respond within 3 days, it is treated as confirmed.

15.7 Only the Admin can formally close a complaint, after the student's confirmation.

15.8 Students may not be penalised in any way for raising a genuine complaint. Knowingly false or malicious complaints, however, may lead to disciplinary action.

15C. Formal grievance committee and appeal

15.9 Grievances that are not settled through the portal can be taken to the Students' Grievance Redressal Committee (SGRC). The SGRC sends its report and recommendations to the Institute, with a copy to the student, preferably within 15 working days of receiving the complaint.

15.10 A student not satisfied with the SGRC's decision may appeal to the Ombudsperson within 15 days of receiving the decision.

15.11 The Ombudsperson makes all efforts to resolve the appeal within 30 days of receiving it.

15.12 Complaints of sexual harassment are handled by the Internal Complaints Committee (Section 9), and complaints of ragging by the Anti-Ragging Committee (Section 8), not by the SGRC.

16. Disciplinary Procedure

16.1 Breaches of these rules are reported to the Discipline Committee. The student concerned is given a written notice and a chance to explain before any decision is taken.

16.2 Depending on the seriousness of the breach, actions may include a warning, a fine, community service on campus, suspension from the hostel, suspension from classes, or expulsion.

16.3 A student may appeal a disciplinary decision to the Director within 7 days of receiving it in writing.

16.4 Parents or guardians are informed of any suspension or expulsion.

17. Important Contacts

Institute contacts below are sample values for the project demo. National helplines are real.

Office / Service	Contact
EchoCampus grievance portal	Log in with your Institute email
Student Welfare Office	welfare@echocampus.example
Student counselling	counsellor@echocampus.example
Internal Complaints Committee (ICC)	icc@echocampus.example
Anti-Ragging Committee	antiragging@echocampus.example
National Anti-Ragging Helpline (24x7, toll free)	1800-180-5522 / helpline@antiragging.in / www.antiragging.in
Tele-MANAS mental health helpline (24x7, free)	14416
National emergency number	112